The Phone Under The Tree Treasure Hunt

Ten clues around your home, ten things that are true before a phone, and one box at the end.





- 10 clue cards
- The hiding map
- The box card
- Our phone promises
- 4 blank clue cards

Every clue card has one line your child reads out loud. By the time they reach the box, they have said the whole plan themselves.

FOR THE GROWN UP · TWENTY MINUTES, THE NIGHT BEFORE

Setting up the hunt

A phone handed over on the sofa arrives with no plan. This one arrives at the end of a hunt, and on the way your child reads out ten things that are true before a phone: where it sleeps, who they tell, what they never spend. By the box, the plan has been said out loud, in their own voice, and it is fun.

1

Print and cut

Pages 4 to 8 are the ten clue cards, two to a page. Cut along the dashed lines. Card stock holds up best.

2

Walk the route

Each card's riddle leads to the place the next card hides. Use the hiding map on page 3. If your home has no bookshelf or no clock, write your own clue on the card, or use a blank card from pages 11 and 12.

3

Hide them in order

Card 1 stays with you. Card 2 goes where card 1's riddle points, card 3 where card 2's points, and so on. Card 10 hides at the charging spot and points to the box.

4

Pack the box

The phone, the box card from page 9 that fits your family, and the promises page folded on top. Wrap it and put it under the tree, or wherever your last clue says.

5

Hand over card 1

Christmas morning, or the day it arrives. Stay close: the lines are meant to be heard. Then open the box together and sign the promises before the phone is switched on.

NOT A PHONE THIS CHRISTMAS?

The hunt still works. Use the second box card on page 9: the box holds the plan, a date you will sit down together, and the promises page. Each card's line becomes something to practise first.

Got the First Phone Kit too? Do its readiness check and setup night after the hunt. The hunt is the door; the kit is the plan behind it.

FOR THE GROWN UP · KEEP THIS ONE HIDDEN

The hiding map

Where each card hides, in order. The printed place is the one the riddles point to. Changed it? Write your place on the line, and tick each card once it is hidden.

CARD 1	**In your hand** Give it to them to start		☐
CARD 2	**The fridge door** Under a magnet	_____	☐
CARD 3	**The kitchen table** Taped underneath	_____	☐
CARD 4	**By the front door** In the biggest shoe	_____	☐
CARD 5	**The bookshelf** Between two books	_____	☐
CARD 6	**Where the keys live** The hook, bowl or drawer	_____	☐
CARD 7	**The sofa** Under a cushion	_____	☐
CARD 8	**The bathroom mirror** Tucked in the frame or taped on	_____	☐
CARD 9	**A clock** Behind or under it	_____	☐
CARD 10	**The charging spot** Where phones sleep at night	_____	☐
THE BOX	**Under the tree** With a box card and the promises on top	_____	☐

1

CLUE 1 OF 10

Start here

READ THIS OUT LOUD

I put my phone down when someone talks to me.

WHERE NEXT?

I am cold inside but I hum all day,
I keep the milk and the cheese away.
Your next clue waits on my big front door,
held up by a magnet, and nothing more.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

2

CLUE 2 OF 10

Found it

READ THIS OUT LOUD

I can spend my stars a bit at a time, not all at once.

WHERE NEXT?

I have four legs but I never walk,
around me the family sits to talk.
Plates go on top and the chairs go round:
look underneath, where the next clue is found.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

3

CLUE 3 OF 10

Keep going

READ THIS OUT LOUD

When we eat together, phones rest. Grown ups too.

WHERE NEXT?

We come in pairs and we wait by the door,
with tongues that cannot talk and laces galore.
Look inside the biggest pair you can find.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

4

CLUE 4 OF 10

Halfway there

READ THIS OUT LOUD

When I am out, I always answer, or ring straight back.

WHERE NEXT?

I have spines but no bones and I am full of tales,
of dragons and football and pirates and whales.
Your next clue is tucked between two books.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

5

CLUE 5 OF 10

Nice work

READ THIS OUT LOUD

A stranger online is still a stranger, however friendly they sound.

WHERE NEXT?

We jingle and jangle and open the door,
without us nobody gets in any more.
Look where the house keys live.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

6

CLUE 6 OF 10

Still going

READ THIS OUT LOUD

I can make a strong password and keep it to myself.

WHERE NEXT?

Everyone sits on me after tea,
I am soft and I am squashy, so come and find me.
Your clue is under a cushion.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

7

CLUE 7 OF 10

Getting close

READ THIS OUT LOUD

I can leave my phone in another room and not mind.

WHERE NEXT?

Look into me and you will see your face,
I copy your smile at the very same pace.
Find the mirror in the bathroom.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

8

CLUE 8 OF 10

Three to go

READ THIS OUT LOUD

I never write anything I would not say to someone's face.

WHERE NEXT?

I have hands but I never clap,
a face but I never take a nap.
I tell you when it is time for bed:
find a clock, and look behind its head.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

9

CLUE 9 OF 10

Nearly there

READ THIS OUT LOUD

My screens go off one hour before bed, every night.

WHERE NEXT?

Every night the phones in this house
come here to rest, as quiet as a mouse.
Find the place where the chargers live.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

10

CLUE 10 OF 10

The last clue

READ THIS OUT LOUD

My phone sleeps here at night, not in my bedroom.
Grown ups' phones too.

WHERE NEXT?

Ten things said and ten clues found,
one last place to look around.
Where the presents wait beside the tree,
there is a box with your name. Go and see.

DIFFERENT HOME? WRITE YOUR OWN CLUE HERE

INSIDE THE BOX · READ THIS BEFORE YOU OPEN IT

You found it

To _____

Ten clues, ten things said out loud. You already know the plan, because you just said it. One last thing, and this time you both say it.

YOU SAY

"If something online ever feels wrong, I will come and tell you."

YOUR GROWN UP SAYS

"And telling me will never cost you your phone. Nobody is in trouble."

Now sign the promises page together. Then, and only then, switch it on.

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE · USE THE CARD THAT FITS

INSIDE THE BOX · WHEN THE PHONE COMES LATER

You found the plan

To _____

The phone is not in this box yet. The plan is. The ten things you just read out loud are the road to it, and we will practise them together.

ON THIS DATE WE SIT DOWN AND LOOK AT WHAT COMES NEXT

_____

THE FIRST THING WE WILL PRACTISE

_____

Sign the promises page together today, so the plan is ready when the phone is.

SIGN IT TOGETHER · BEFORE IT IS SWITCHED ON

Our phone promises

The lines from the clue cards, written down as a deal. Every promise counts for grown ups too, so the house has one set of rules, not two.

- [ ] **Phones sleep outside bedrooms, grown ups' phones included.**
  At the charging spot from clue 10.

- [ ] **Screens go off one hour before bed, every night.**
  Ours go off at _____

- [ ] **Phones rest while we eat.**
  Grown ups too. It will still be there after.

- [ ] **When I am out, I always answer, or ring straight back.**

- [ ] **We never write what we would not say to a face.**

- [ ] **Never spend real money without asking first.**

- [ ] **If something goes wrong online, tell a grown up straight away, and nobody is in trouble.**
  Telling never costs the phone.

- [ ] **One promise we are adding ourselves**
  _____

SIGNED, THE PHONE'S OWNER

_____

SIGNED, THE GROWN UP

_____

Look at it again together on _____. A promise that is working can loosen. One that is not gets talked about, not taken away.

YOUR OWN CLUE

Write it yourself

READ THIS OUT LOUD

WHERE NEXT?

IT HIDES AT

CUT ALONG THE DASHED LINE

YOUR OWN CLUE

Write it yourself

READ THIS OUT LOUD

WHERE NEXT?

IT HIDES AT

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